

Income in the United States: 2025

Current Population Reports

By Melissa Kollar and Zach Scherer

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George M. Cook,
Performing the Duties of the Director

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Contents

INTRODUCTION	1
Highlights	1
HOUSEHOLD INCOME	1
Post-Tax Household Income	3
INCOME INEQUALITY	3
Money Income Inequality	4
Post-Tax Income Inequality	4
EARNINGS AND WORK STATUS	4
Sex	7
SUMMARY	8
ENDNOTES	9
FIGURES	
Figure 1. Median Household Income and Percent Change by Selected Characteristics	2
Figure 2. Real Median Household Income by Race and Hispanic Origin: 1967 to 2025	3
Figure 3. Selected Income Inequality Measures Using Money Income: 1967 to 2025	5
Figure 4. Selected Income Measures Using Post-Tax Income and Money Income: 2025	6
Figure 5. Median Earnings and Percent Change by Selected Characteristics	7
Figure 6. Female-to-Male Earnings Ratio and Median Earnings of Full-Time, Year-Round Workers by Sex: 1960 to 2025 ...	8
APPENDIXES	
APPENDIX A. ESTIMATES OF INCOME	10
How Income Is Measured	10
Post-Tax Income	10
Business Cycles—Recessions	11
Cost-of-Living Adjustment	11
Endnotes	12
APPENDIX B. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION	13
Source and Accuracy of the Estimates	13
CPS ASEC Modernization	14
National Experimental Well-Being Statistics (NEWS) Project	14
Accessing Income Data	14
Other Sources of Income Data	14
Questions and Comments	15

ONLINE TABLES

(Available at <www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html>.)

- Table 1. Income Summary Measures by Selected Characteristics: 2024 and 2025
- Table 2. Households by Total Money Income, Race, and Hispanic Origin of Householder: 1967 to 2025
- Table 3. Post-Tax Household Income Summary Measures by Selected Characteristics: 2024 and 2025
- Table 4. Summary Measures by Selected Characteristics Using Money Income and Post-Tax Income: 2025
- Table 5. Income Distribution Measures Using Money Income and Equivalence-Adjusted Income: 2024 and 2025
- Table 6. Selected Measures of Household Income Dispersion: 1967 to 2025
- Table 7. Selected Measures of Equivalence-Adjusted Income Dispersion: 1967 to 2025
- Table 8. Distribution Measures Using Post-Tax Income and Equivalence-Adjusted Post-Tax Income: 2024 and 2025
- Table 9. Distribution Measures Using Money Income, Post-Tax Income, Equivalence-Adjusted Income, and Equivalence-Adjusted Post-Tax Income: 2025
- Table 10. Selected Measures of Household Post-Tax Income Dispersion: 2009 to 2025
- Table 11. Earnings Summary Measures by Selected Characteristics: 2024 and 2025
- Table 12. Number and Real Median Earning of Total Workers and Full-Time, Year-Round Workers With Earnings by Sex and Female-to-Male Earnings Ratio: 1960 to 2025

Income in the United States: 2025

INTRODUCTION

The U.S. Census Bureau collects data and publishes estimates on income, earnings, and inequality to evaluate national economic trends and understand their effect on the well-being of households, families, and individuals.

The estimates in this report are based on data collected in the 2026 and earlier Current Population Survey Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC) conducted by the Census Bureau.* Estimates for 2024 in this report may not match those published last year due to the implementation of Vintage 2025 population controls.¹ This report presents estimates on income in the United States for calendar year 2025. Historical estimates are expressed in real or 2025 dollars to account for the change in the cost of living over time.²

This report is released alongside two other reports focused on poverty and health insurance in the United States: “Poverty in the

United States: 2025” and “Health Insurance Coverage in the United States: 2025.”³

Highlights

- In 2025, median household income was \$87,460, an increase of 2.6 percent from the 2024 estimate of \$85,210 (Figure 1).⁴ Household income in 2025 was the highest on record dating back to 1967.
- Between 2024 and 2025, median income increased by 3.0 percent for White households, 2.9 percent for non-Hispanic White households, and 4.8 percent for Black households. Median income did not change significantly for Asian or Hispanic households (Figure 2).⁵
- Median household income after accounting for taxes and credits increased by 3.1 percent, from \$73,760 in 2024 to \$76,060 in 2025.
- Income inequality as measured by the Gini index was not significantly different between 2024 and 2025 (Figure 3).
- Household income increased 1.7 percent at the 90th percentile but did not significantly change at the 10th percentile between 2024 and 2025.
- Among full-time, year-round workers, median earnings increased 3.2 percent for women but did not change significantly for men between 2024 and 2025 (Figure 5).

- For full-time, year-round workers, the female-to-male earnings ratio in 2025 increased to 83.9 percent from 80.6 percent in 2024 (Figure 6).

HOUSEHOLD INCOME

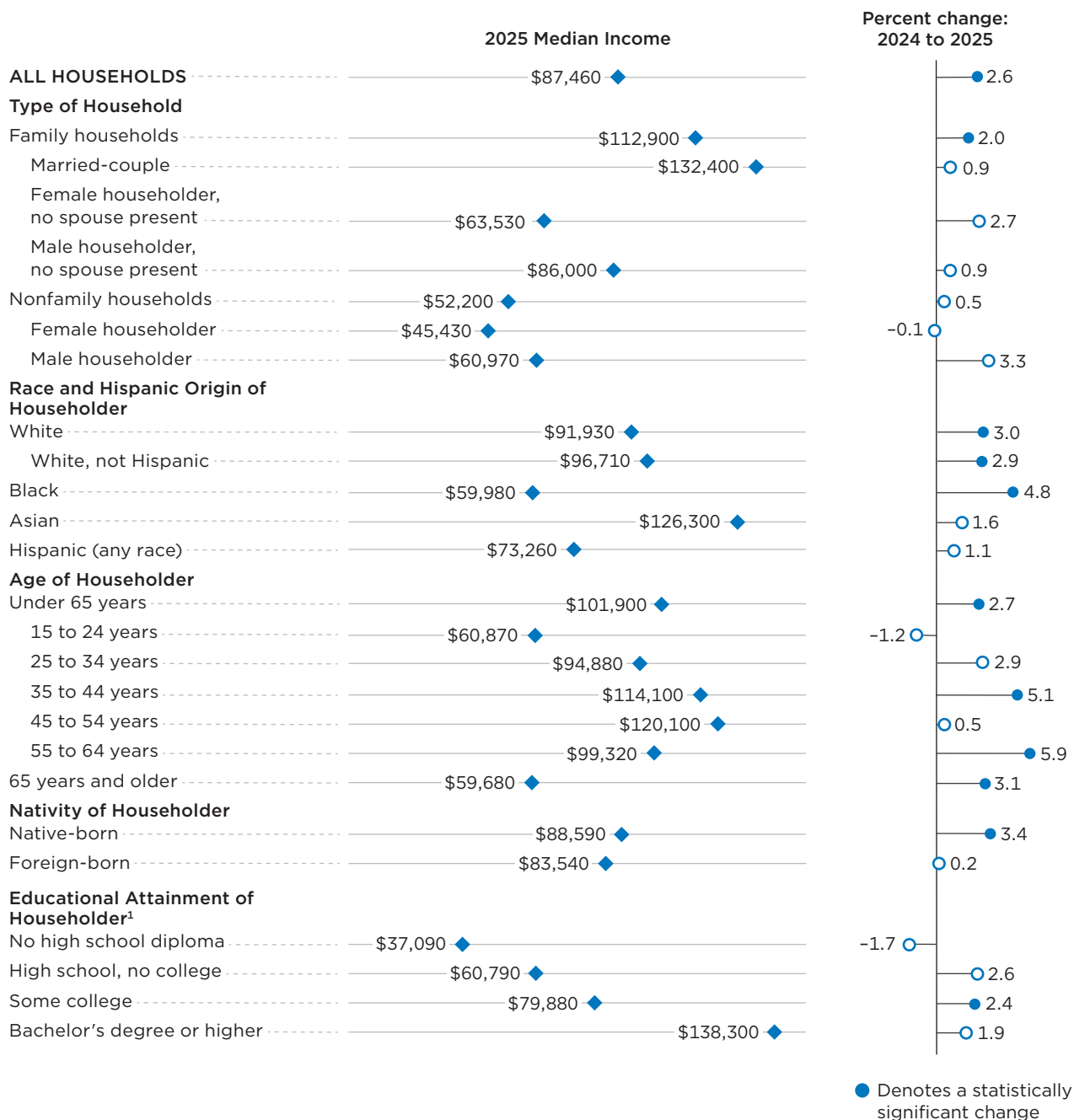
This section presents estimates of median household income based on money income, which is pretax and does not account for the value of in-kind transfers. The householder is the person (or one of the people) in whose name the home is owned or rented and the person to whom the relationship of other household members is recorded. Each household has only one householder, so the number of householders is equal to the number of households. Group quarters are excluded from the household population.⁶

In 2025, median household income was \$87,460, an increase of 2.6 percent from the 2024 estimate of \$85,210 (Figure 1).⁷ Household income in 2025 was the highest on record dating back to 1967 (Figure 2).

For all demographic characteristics of the householder shown in Figure 1, the median household income estimates in 2025 were either higher than the 2024 estimates or were not statistically different from 2024.⁸ Median household income increased by 3.0 percent for White households, 2.9 percent for non-Hispanic White households, and 4.8 percent for Black households.⁹ Median income did not change significantly for Asian or Hispanic households.¹⁰

* The U.S. Census Bureau has reviewed this data product to ensure appropriate access, use, and disclosure avoidance protection of the confidential source data used to produce this product (Data Management System [DMS] number: P-7534374 and Disclosure Review Board [DRB] approval number: CBDREB-FY26-0279). To further protect respondent privacy, all estimates in this report have undergone additional rounding. As a result, details may not sum to totals. All comparative statements have undergone statistical testing and are statistically significant at the 90 percent confidence level unless otherwise noted. More information on confidentiality protection, methodology, sampling and nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <<https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>>.

Figure 1.

Median Household Income and Percent Change by Selected Characteristics

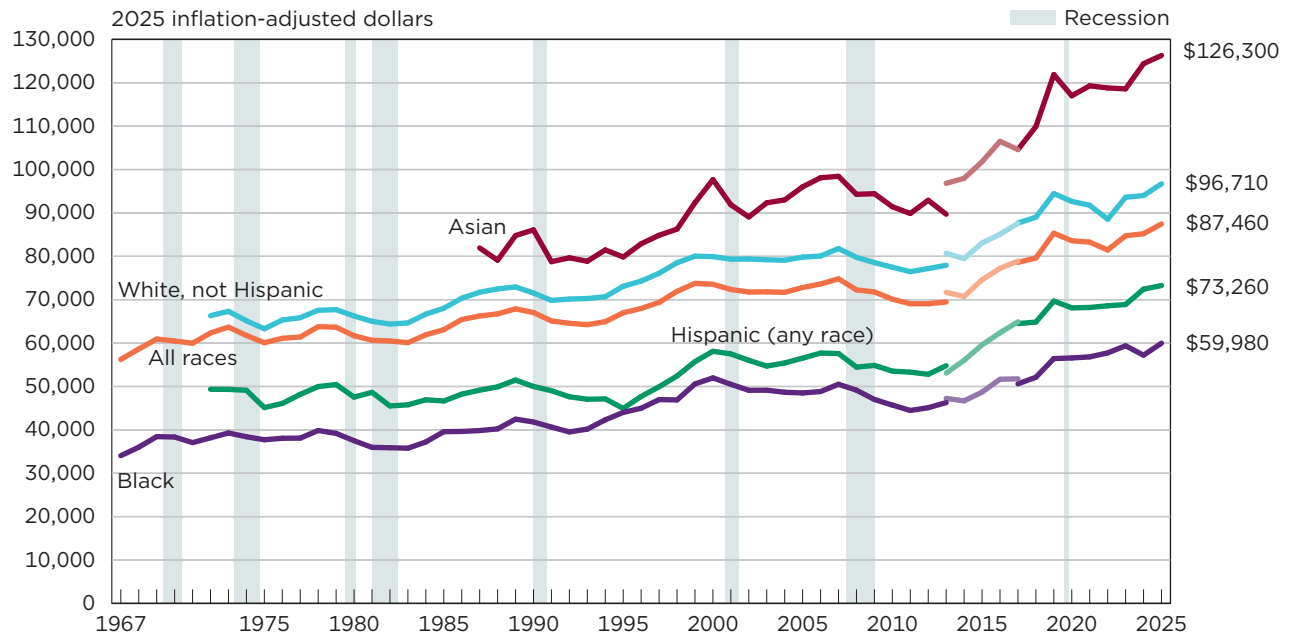
¹ Householders 25 years and older. In 2025, the median household income for this group was \$89,660.

Note: Households as of March of the following year. Statistically significant indicates the change is statistically different from zero at the 90 percent confidence level. Margins of error and other related estimates are available in Table 1 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 2025 and 2026 Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC; DMS number P-7534374 and DRB approval number CBDRB-FY26-0279).

Figure 2.

Real Median Household Income by Race and Hispanic Origin: 1967 to 2025



Note: Households as of March of the following year. The data points are placed at the midpoints of the respective years. More information on the inflation adjustment and recessions is available in Appendix A. Historical race footnotes, footnotes about breaks in series in 2013 and 2017, and margins of error are available in Table 2 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 1968 to 2026 Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC; DMS number P-7534374 and DRB approval number CBDRB-FY26-0279).

Figure 2 shows historical median household income by race and Hispanic origin.¹¹

Post-Tax Household Income

Tax policies have an important effect on the total resources available to households for consumption, and an income measure that accounts for these costs and benefits is an important indicator of household well-being. Post-tax income is defined as money income net of federal and state income taxes and credits, payroll taxes (FICA), and temporary cash payments administered by tax agencies like rebates or stimulus

payments. Refer to Appendix A for additional details on the creation of post-tax income estimates.

Median post-tax household income increased between 2024 and 2025 by 3.1 percent, from \$73,760 to \$76,060, not significantly different from the 2.6 percent increase in pretax household income.¹²

When accounting for all taxes and credits, median household income was 13.0 percent lower in 2025 compared to pretax income, which was not significantly different from the 13.4 percent difference in 2024. For all demographic groups

examined in this report, median post-tax income was significantly lower than pretax income.¹³

INCOME INEQUALITY

Income inequality refers to how evenly income or income growth is distributed across the population—higher income inequality represents less equal income distribution or growth. This report presents several measures of income inequality: the Gini index, the ratio of income percentiles, and the shares of aggregate household income by quintiles.

Money Income Inequality¹⁴

Based on the money income Gini index, income inequality was not statistically different between 2024 and 2025; the Gini index was 0.490 in 2025 (Figure 3).

Changes in income between 2024 and 2025 were not constant across the income distribution. Household income increased 1.7 percent at the 90th percentile but did not significantly change at the 10th percentile.¹⁵

The ratio of the 90th percentile to 10th percentile was 13.06 in 2025, meaning income at the 90th percentile (\$261,300) was 13 times higher than income at the 10th percentile (\$20,010). The ratio of the 90th to 10th percentiles was not statistically different from the 2024 ratio of 12.74 (Figure 3). The ratio of the 50th to 10th percentiles increased 3.5 percent, from 4.22 in 2024 to 4.37 in 2025, while the ratio of the 90th to 50th percentiles did not differ significantly between 2024 and 2025.¹⁶

The quintile shares of aggregate household income show how much total income each group in the income distribution received during the year. In 2025, households in the lowest quintile received 3.0 percent of aggregate household income, while households in the highest quintile received 52.4 percent of aggregate household income (Figure 3). The top 5 percent of households received 23.5 percent of aggregate household income. Between 2024 and 2025, the changes in the shares of aggregate household income by quintile were not statistically significant.¹⁷

INCOME INEQUALITY MEASURES

Gini index: A statistical measure of income inequality ranging from 0.0 to 1.0, where 0.0 represents perfect equality and 1.0 indicates total inequality. It measures how far apart or “spread out” incomes are from one another.

Percentile: The dollar amount below which a given percentage of households fall. The 50th percentile is also referred to as the median—one-half of households have income above the median, and one-half are below the median.

Quintile: A quintile is one of five equal groups ranked by income from lowest to highest, so that 20 percent of all households are in each group.

Additional inequality measures, as well as corresponding equivalence-adjusted inequality measures, are available at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

Post-Tax Income Inequality

Because taxes and tax credits affect lower- and higher-income households differently, the post-tax income distribution and post-tax income inequality differ from similar pretax, money income measures.

Comparing inequality measures using pretax money income and post-tax income in 2025 illustrates the redistributive nature of the income tax system. In 2025, after accounting for taxes and credits, aggregate shares of income in the bottom four quintiles were higher, while the share of aggregate income of the highest quintile was lower (Figure 4). Inequality, as measured by the Gini index, was 8.7 percent lower when calculated using post-tax income compared to pretax income.¹⁸

The Gini index calculated using post-tax income was 0.448 in 2025, not significantly different from the 2024 estimate (0.447).¹⁹ Additionally, there was

no statistically significant change in post-tax income inequality between 2024 and 2025 as measured by the percentile income ratios or the shares of aggregate income by quintiles.

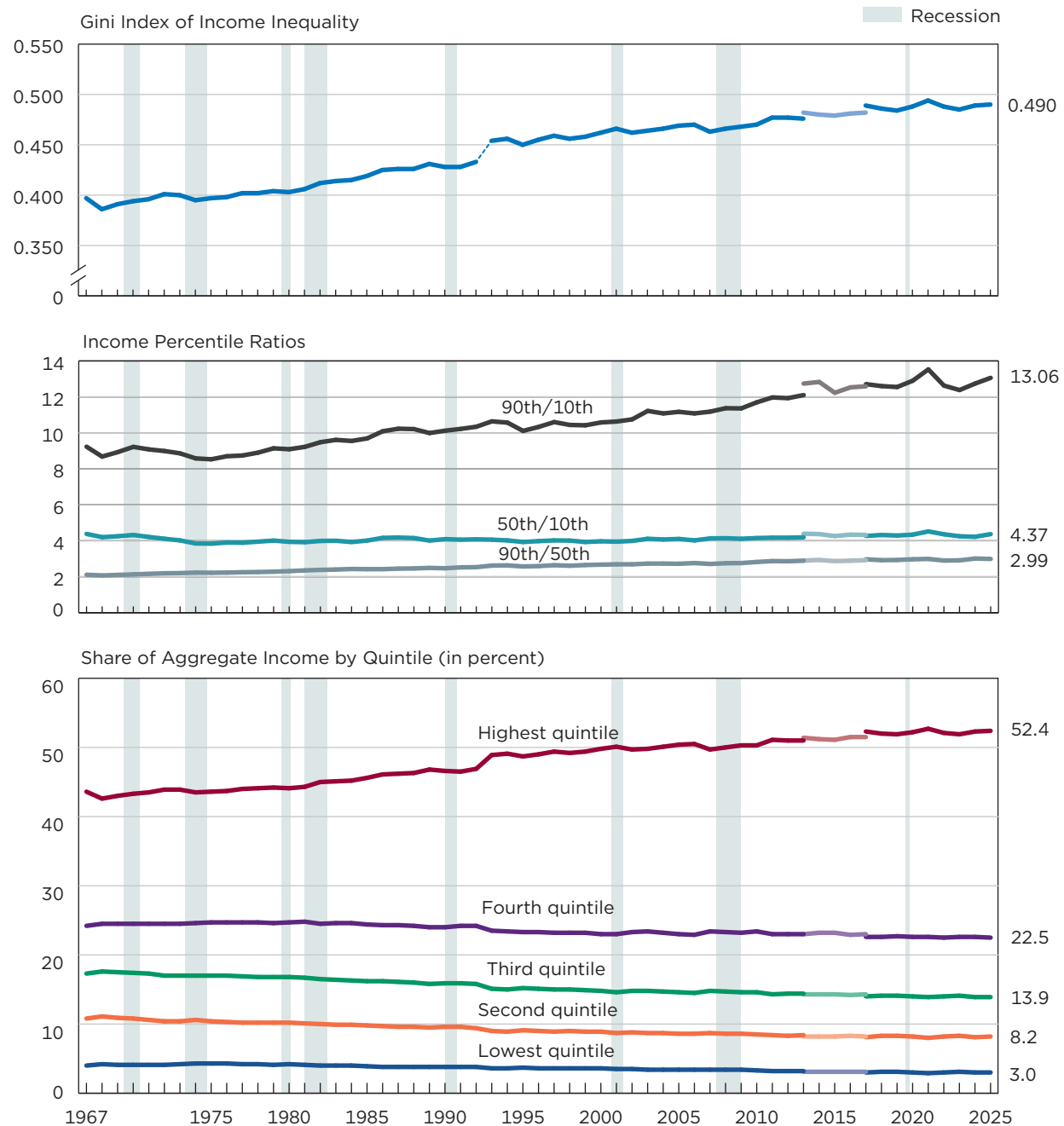
EARNINGS AND WORK STATUS

This section presents estimates of real median earnings by work status for individuals age 15 and older with earnings. Earnings are the sum of wage and salary income and nonfarm and farm self-employment income (gross receipts minus expenses). In 2025, earnings constituted 75.9 percent of aggregate total income.

Total workers (also referred to as “all workers”) include both part-time and full-time workers. A full-time, year-round worker is a person who worked at least 35 hours per week (full-time) and at least 50 weeks per year (year-round).²⁰ In 2025, 70.7 percent of workers were employed full-time, year-round, an increase from 69.7 percent in 2024.

Figure 3.

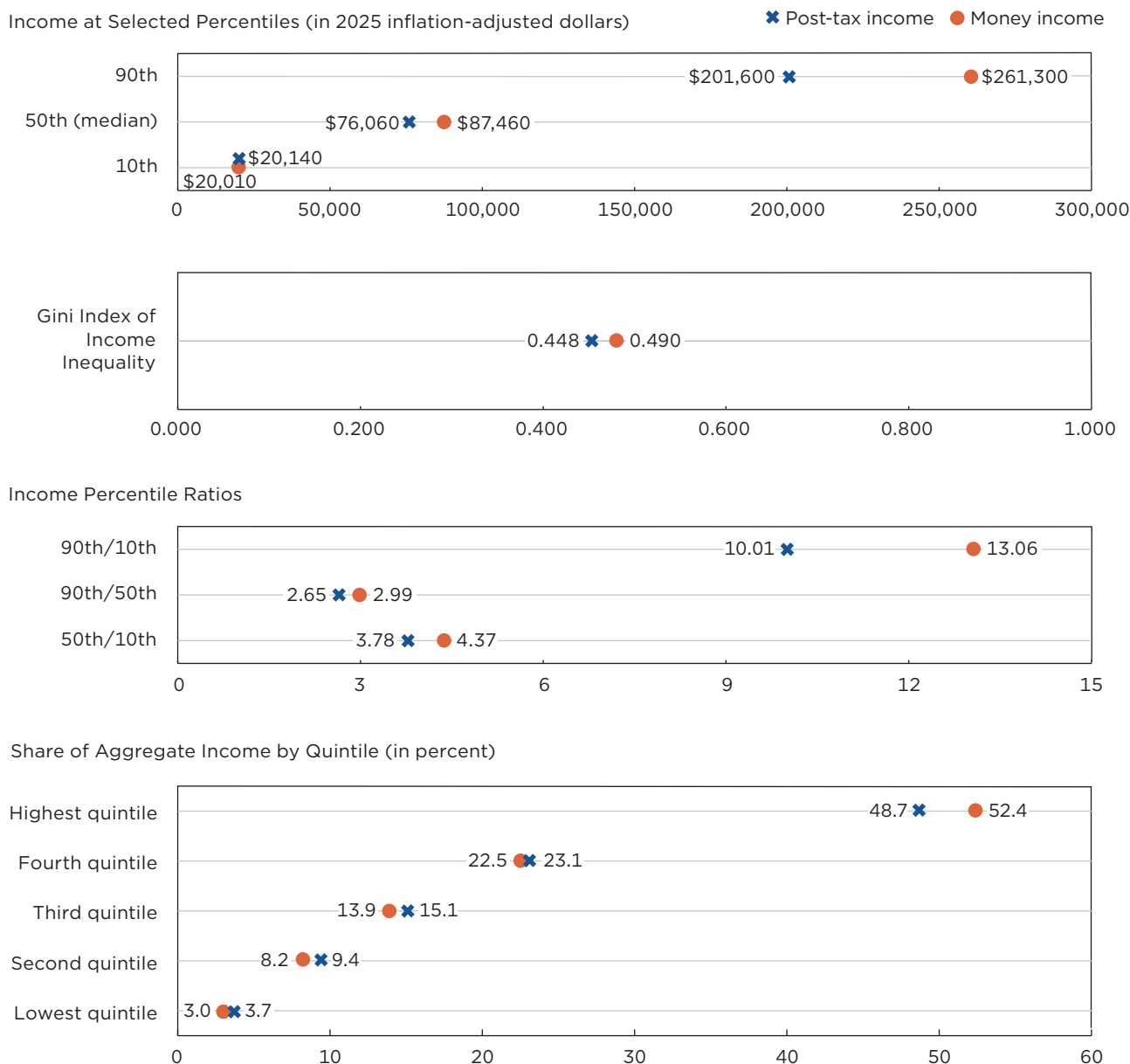
Selected Income Inequality Measures Using Money Income: 1967 to 2025



Note: Income is in 2025 dollars. The data points are placed at the midpoints of the respective years. More information on the inflation adjustment and recessions is available in Appendix A. Historical footnotes, including footnotes about breaks in series in 2013 and 2017, are available in Table 6 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 1968 to 2026 Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC; DMS number P-7534374 and DRB approval number CBDRB-FY26-0279).

Figure 4.
Selected Income Measures Using Post-Tax Income and Money Income: 2025



Note: Margins of error and other related estimates are available in Table 9 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 2026 Annual Social and Economic Supplement (CPS ASEC; DMS number P-7534374 and DRB approval number CBDRB-FY26-0279).

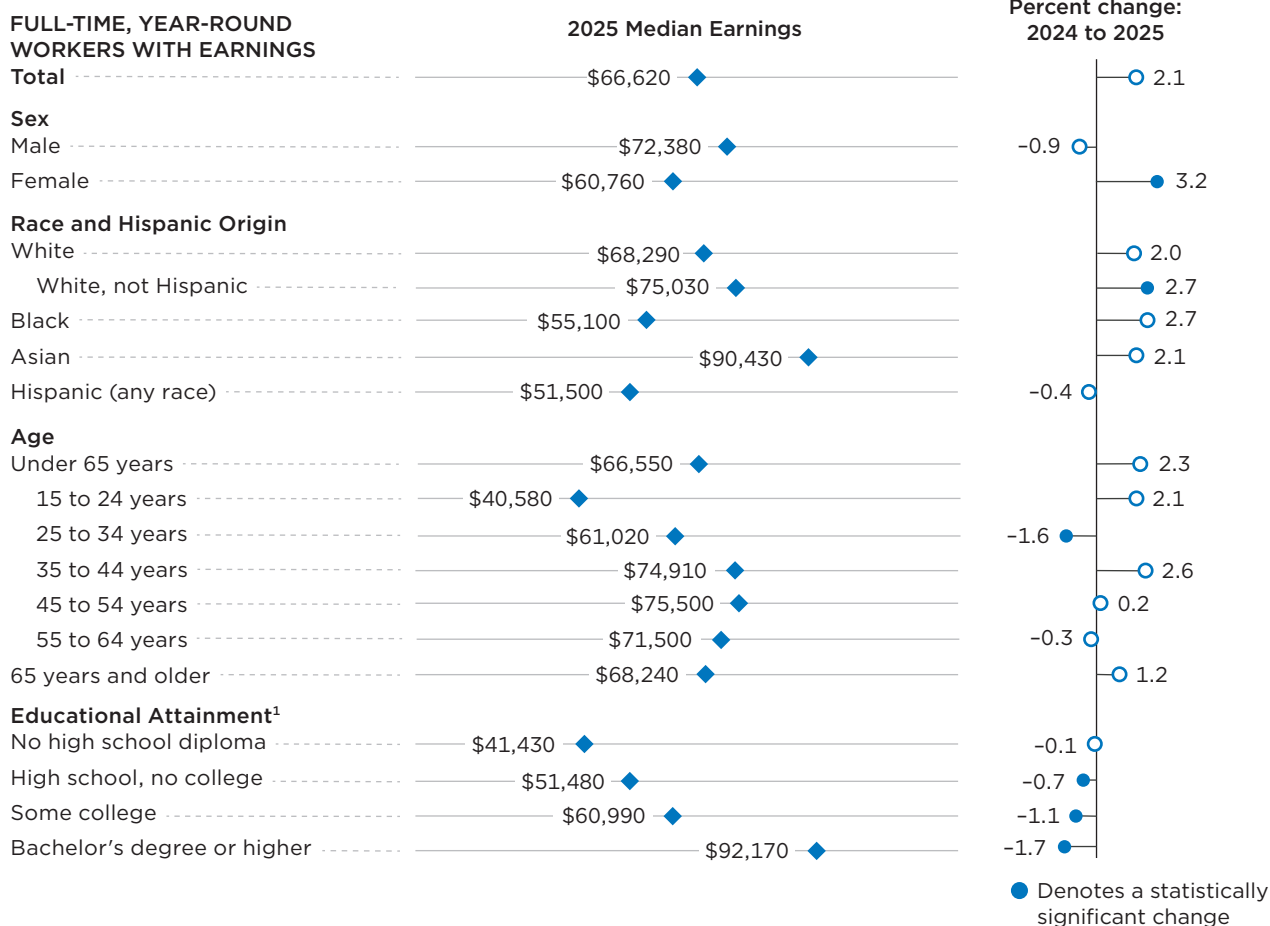
In 2025, median earnings were \$52,770 for all workers and \$66,620 for full-time, year-round workers.²¹ The changes in median earnings between 2024 and 2025 for both all workers and full-time,

year-round workers were not statistically significant.

Figure 5 presents median earnings for full-time, year-round workers by sex, race and Hispanic origin, age, and educational attainment.²²

Median earnings for female and non-Hispanic White full-time, year-round workers increased in 2025. Median earnings among full-time, year-round workers ages 25 to 34, with a high school diploma,

Figure 5.

Median Earnings and Percent Change by Selected Characteristics

¹ People age 25 years and older. In 2025, the median earnings for this group was \$70,250.

Note: People 15 years and older, as of March of the following year, with earnings. Statistically significant indicates the change is statistically different from zero at the 90 percent confidence level. Margins of error, other related estimates, and notes are available in Table 11 at <www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html>. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <<https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>>. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 2025 and 2026 Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC; DMS number P-7534374 and DRB approval number CBDRB-FY26-0279).

with some college education, and with a bachelor's degree or higher declined from 2024 to 2025.²³ Differences between 2024 and 2025 were not significant for the other groups shown.

Sex

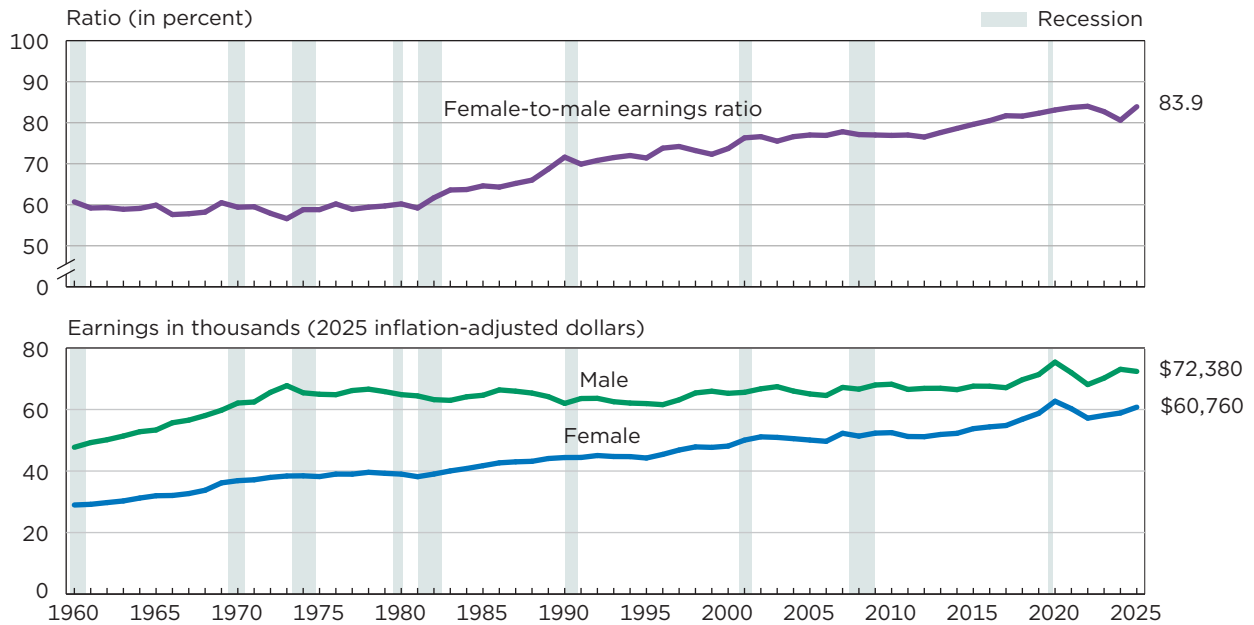
The share of male workers employed full-time, year-round increased to 75.6 percent in 2025 from 74.3 percent in 2024. The

share of female workers employed full-time, year-round was 65.4 percent in 2025, an increase from 64.6 percent in 2024.

The median earnings of men who worked full-time, year-round (\$72,380) did not change significantly compared to 2024, while median earnings of women who worked full-time, year-round (\$60,760) increased by 3.2 percent (Figure 5).

The female-to-male earnings ratio compares the median earnings of women working full-time, year-round to the median earnings of men working full-time, year-round. The 2025 female-to-male earnings ratio was 0.839, a 4.2 percent increase from the 2024 ratio (0.806) (Figure 6).²⁴ This increase follows 2 years of statistically significant declines in the female-to-male-earnings ratio and marks the first significant year-over-year increase in the ratio since 2016.

Figure 6.
Female-to-Male Earnings Ratio and Median Earnings of Full-Time, Year-Round Workers by Sex: 1960 to 2025



Note: People age 15 years and older, as of March of the following year, with earnings. The data points are placed at the midpoints of the respective years. More information on the inflation adjustment and recessions is available in Appendix A. Historical footnotes and margins of error are available in Table 12 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 1961 to 2026 Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC; DMS number P-7534374 and DRB approval number CBDRB-FY26-0279).

SUMMARY

This report provides estimates of household income, income inequality, and worker earnings in the United States for 2025. These measures are useful tools to evaluate economic trends and well-being.

Median household income increased from 2024 to 2025,

both before and after accounting for taxes and credits. Pretax median household income was the highest on record dating back to 1967. Both pretax and post-tax household income increased at the 90th percentile but did not significantly change at the 10th percentile between 2024 and 2025.

Median earnings among all workers and among full-time, year-round workers did not change significantly from 2024 to 2025. Median earnings among women who worked full-time, year-round increased, and the female-to-male earnings ratio among full-time, year-round workers increased from 2024 to 2025.

ENDNOTES

¹ Additional details are available at www.census.gov/library/working-papers/2026/demo/sehsd-wp2026-16.html.

² “Real” refers to income after adjusting for inflation. The current method for inflation adjustment is based on the Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U) between 2000 and 2025. The C-CPI-U measured a 2.5 percent increase in consumer prices between 2024 and 2025. Refer to the Cost-of-Living Adjustment section in Appendix A for more information.

³ Christina Bijou and Emily A. Shrider, “Poverty in the United States: 2025,” *Current Population Reports*, P60-290, U.S. Census Bureau, Washington, DC, September 2026, www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-290.html, and Lisa N. Bunch and Halelujha Ketema, “Health Insurance Coverage in the United States: 2025,” *Current Population Reports*, P60-291, U.S. Census Bureau, Washington, DC, September 2026, www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-291.html.

⁴ Median income is the amount that divides the income distribution into two equal groups, one-half having incomes above the median and one-half having incomes below the median. Calculated differences throughout this report may differ due to rounding. The margin of error for median household income in 2025 was \$1,040.

⁵ The differences among the 2024–2025 percent changes in median household income for all race and ethnicity groups were not statistically significant.

⁶ In the CPS ASEC, group quarters are noninstitutional living arrangements for groups not living in conventional housing units or groups living in housing units containing nine or more people unrelated to the person in charge.

⁷ Estimates for 2024 in this report may not match those published last year due to the implementation of Vintage 2025 population controls.

⁸ Median household income estimates by additional characteristics for 2024 and 2025 are available in Table 1 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

⁹ Federal surveys give respondents the option of reporting more than one race. Therefore, two basic ways of defining a race group are possible. A group, such as Asian, may be defined as those who reported Asian and no other race (the race-alone or single-race concept) or as those who reported Asian regardless of whether they also reported another race (the race-alone-or-in-combination concept). The body of this report (text and figures) shows data using the first approach (race alone). The online tables show data using both approaches. Primary use of the single-race population does not imply that it is the preferred method of presenting or analyzing data. The Census Bureau uses a variety of approaches. In this report, the terms “White, not Hispanic” and “non-Hispanic White” are used interchangeably and refer to people who are not Hispanic and who reported White and no other race. This report uses non-Hispanic White as the comparison group for other race and Hispanic origin groups. Since Hispanic individuals may be of any race, data in this report for the Hispanic population overlap with data for race groups. Data users should be aware that the different race and Hispanic origin populations consist of many distinct groups that differ in socioeconomic characteristics, culture, and nativity, which may affect the interpretation of aggregate results. Data identifying Hispanic individuals were first collected in 1972 and for Asian and Pacific Islander individuals in 1987. More information is available at www.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps.html.

¹⁰ The differences among the 2024–2025 percent changes in median household income for all race and ethnicity groups were not statistically significant.

¹¹ Historical median household income estimates for additional race and Hispanic origin groups are available in Table 2 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

¹² Median post-tax household income estimates by select demographic characteristics for 2024 and 2025 are available in Table 3 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

¹³ Comparisons of pretax and post-tax median household income by select demographic characteristics are available in Table 4 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

¹⁴ Money income is the baseline measure of income in this report. Money income is calculated pretax, meaning these inequality estimates do not reflect the direct redistributive effects of tax policy. Refer to Appendix A for a detailed list of all income components.

¹⁵ Income inequality estimates by select demographic characteristics for 2024 and 2025 are available in Table 5 and historical inequality estimates for money income and equivalence-adjusted income are available in Tables 6 and 7 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

¹⁶ The difference between the 2024–2025 percent changes in the ratio of the 90th to the 10th percentiles and the ratio of the 50th to the 10th percentiles was not statistically significant.

¹⁷ The differences among the 2024–2025 percent changes in the share of aggregate household income were not statistically significant.

¹⁸ Comparisons of pretax and post-tax income inequality by select demographic characteristics are available in Table 9 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

¹⁹ Post-tax income inequality estimates by select demographic characteristics for 2024 and 2025 are available in Table 8, and historical post-tax income inequality estimates are available in Table 10 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

²⁰ For school personnel, summer vacation is counted as weeks worked if they are scheduled to return to their job in the fall. For more detailed information on work experience, refer to Table PINC-05, “Work Experience in 2025—People 15 Years Old and Over by Total Money Earnings in 2025, Age, Race, Hispanic Origin, and Sex” at www.census.gov/data/tables/time-series/demo/income-poverty/cps-pinc/pinc-05.html.

²¹ The margin of error for 2025 median earnings for all workers was \$954.

²² Median earnings estimates by additional characteristics for 2024 and 2025 are available in Table 11 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

²³ Educational attainment is measured among those age 25 and older.

²⁴ Historical estimates of number of workers and median earnings by sex are available in Table 12 at www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html.

Appendix A. Estimates of Income

HOW INCOME IS MEASURED

For each person 15 years and older in the sample, the Current Population Survey Annual Social and Economic Supplement (CPS ASEC) asks questions on the amount of money income received in the preceding calendar year from each of the following sources:

1. Earnings.
2. Unemployment compensation.
3. Workers' compensation.
4. Social Security.
5. Supplemental Security Income.
6. Public assistance.
7. Veterans' payments.
8. Survivor benefits.
9. Disability benefits.
10. Pension or retirement income.
11. Interest.
12. Dividends.
13. Rents, royalties, and estates and trusts.
14. Educational assistance.
15. Alimony.
16. Child support.
17. Financial assistance from outside of the household.
18. Other income.

Data on income collected in the CPS ASEC by the U.S. Census Bureau cover money income received (exclusive of certain money receipts such as capital gains) before payments for personal income taxes, Social Security, union dues, Medicare deductions, and any other deductions. Money income also excludes tax credits such as the Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC). Money income does not reflect

that some families receive non-cash benefits such as nutritional assistance, health benefits, and subsidized housing. In addition, money income does not reflect that noncash benefits often take the form of the use of business transportation and facilities, full or partial payments by businesses for retirement programs, medical and educational expenses, etc.

Although the income statistics refer to receipts during the preceding calendar year, the demographic characteristics, such as age, labor force status, and household composition, are as of the survey date. The income of the household does not include amounts received by people who were members during all or part of the previous year if these people no longer resided in the household at the time of the interview. The CPS ASEC collects income data for people who are current residents but did not reside in the household during the previous year. Data users should consider these elements when comparing income levels. For many different reasons, many respondents tend to misreport or not report their income sources.¹ Income earned from wages or salaries is the largest component of money income and tends to be more accurately reported than other income sources. The weighted totals for wages and salaries are in line with other aggregate benchmarks.² Still, estimates in this report are affected by ongoing challenges of nonresponse and misreporting. More details on the effect of nonresponse bias are available in Appendix B.

POST-TAX INCOME

Money income is pretax, which means it does not account for tax liabilities or credits. Tax policies have an important effect on the total resources available to households for consumption, and an income measure that accounts for these costs and benefits is also an important indicator of household well-being.

Post-tax income is defined as money income net of federal and state income taxes and credits, payroll taxes (FICA), and temporary cash payments administered by tax agencies like rebates or stimulus payments.

Since the CPS ASEC does not collect information on taxes, the Census Bureau relies on a tax calculator to simulate federal and state taxes paid and credits received. Post-tax income estimates used in this report and the Supplemental Poverty Measure (SPM) are based on output from the CPS ASEC Tax Model. These simulations include federal, state, and select local income taxes, as well as FICA taxes, and incorporate changes in federal, state, and local tax laws for tax year 2025. For post-tax poverty estimates, refer to the SPM estimates in the report "Poverty in the United States: 2025."³

The 2025 tax model incorporated federal tax policy changes, including a new enhanced senior deduction for adults age 65 and older, an increase in the maximum child tax credit amount per qualifying child, and an increase in the state and local tax deductions cap.

Additionally, several components of the tax model were inflation-adjusted, including the federal income tax brackets, the standard deduction, and the thresholds and amounts used to calculate the federal EITC. Due to data limitations in the CPS ASEC, the new deductions for tip and overtime income were not included in the tax model.⁴

The 2025 tax model also incorporated state-level policy changes. This includes accounting for states that added or expanded their state EITC or child tax credit programs, and accounting for states that changed their tax rates from a progressive tax rate to a flat tax rate or that fully phased out their state income tax.

Details on the tax model methodology and more information on changes for 2025 can be found at www.census.gov/topics/income-poverty/income/guidance/tax-model.html.

BUSINESS CYCLES—RECESSIONS

Business cycle peaks and troughs used to delineate the beginning and end of recessions, as shown in the text box “Business Cycles—Recessions,” are determined by the National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER), a private research organization. The data points in the time series charts in this report use July as a reference. According to the NBER chronology, the most recent peak occurred in February 2020. The most recent trough occurred in April 2020. More information on business cycle dating is available at www.nber.org/research/business-cycle-dating.

Business Cycles—Recessions

Peak month	Year	Trough month	Year
November	1948	October	1949
July	1953	May	1954
August	1957	April	1958
April	1960	February	1961
December	1969	November	1970
November	1973	March	1975
January	1980	July	1980
July	1981	November	1982
July	1990	March	1991
March	2001	November	2001
December	2007	June	2009
February	2020	April	2020

Source: National Bureau of Economic Research, www.nber.org/research/data/us-business-cycle-expansions-and-contractions.

COST-OF-LIVING ADJUSTMENT

To accurately assess changes in income and earnings over time, an adjustment for changes in the cost of living is required. This report and the associated tables and figures adjust historical income estimates using price indexes produced by the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS). The Census Bureau combines several price indexes because no single price index is available for all years for which income estimates are available. The Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U) is used between 2000 and 2025, and the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers Retroactive Series (R-CPI-U-RS) is used between 1978 and 1999. For years 1967 through 1977, the Census Bureau uses the CPI-U-X1 series, which is an experimental series that preceded the R-CPI-U-RS and estimates the inflation

rate in the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U) when applying the current rental equivalence method of measuring the cost of homeownership for years prior to 1983. For years before 1967, the Census Bureau uses the CPI-U. To combine these four series into one continuous series, the values in each range of years are proportionally adjusted using the ratio or ratios of index values from subsequent overlapping series years: 1967, 1978, and 2000. For example, CPI-U values prior to 1967 are adjusted to the C-CPI-U scale using the ratio of the CPI-U to CPI-U-X1 in 1967, the ratio of the CPI-U-X1 to R-CPI-U-RS in 1978, and the ratio of the C-CPI-U to the R-CPI-U-RS in 2000. The index values constructed for this continuous series are shown in the text box “Annual Index Value and Annual Percent Change in Price Series Used to Adjust Historical Income Estimates: 1947 to 2025.”

Annual Index Value and Annual Percent Change in Price Series Used to Adjust Historical Income Estimates: 1947 to 2025

Income year	C-CPI-U ¹ (December 1999 = 100)	Percent change from year prior	Income year	C-CPI-U ¹ (December 1999 = 100)	Percent change from year prior
1947.....	15.1	X	1987.....	70.3	3.4
1948.....	16.4	8.6	1988.....	72.9	3.7
1949.....	16.2	-1.2	1989.....	76.1	4.4
1950.....	16.4	1.2	1990.....	79.8	4.9
1951.....	17.7	7.9	1991.....	82.7	3.6
1952.....	18.0	1.7	1992.....	84.8	2.5
1953.....	18.1	0.6	1993.....	86.9	2.5
1954.....	18.3	1.1	1994.....	88.8	2.2
1955.....	18.2	-0.5	1995.....	90.9	2.4
1956.....	18.5	1.6	1996.....	93.3	2.6
1957.....	19.1	3.2	1997.....	95.3	2.1
1958.....	19.6	2.6	1998.....	96.6	1.4
1959.....	19.8	1.0	1999.....	98.6	2.1
1960.....	20.1	1.5	2000.....	102.0	3.4
1961.....	20.3	1.0	2001.....	104.3	2.3
1962.....	20.5	1.0	2002.....	105.6	1.2
1963.....	20.8	1.5	2003.....	107.8	2.1
1964.....	21.0	1.0	2004.....	110.5	2.5
1965.....	21.4	1.9	2005.....	113.7	2.9
1966.....	22.0	2.8	2006.....	117.0	2.9
1967.....	22.7	3.2	2007.....	120.0	2.6
1968.....	23.6	4.0	2008.....	124.4	3.7
1969.....	24.6	4.2	2009.....	123.9	-0.4
1970.....	25.8	4.9	2010.....	125.6	1.4
1971.....	26.9	4.3	2011.....	129.5	3.1
1972.....	27.8	3.3	2012.....	132.0	1.9
1973.....	29.5	6.1	2013.....	133.6	1.2
1974.....	32.4	9.8	2014.....	135.5	1.4
1975.....	35.1	8.3	2015.....	135.4	-0.1
1976.....	37.1	5.7	2016.....	136.6	0.9
1977.....	39.5	6.5	2017.....	139.0	1.8
1978.....	42.2	6.8	2018.....	141.8	2.0
1979.....	46.2	9.5	2019.....	143.9	1.5
1980.....	51.3	11.0	2020.....	145.4	1.0
1981.....	56.2	9.6	2021.....	151.9	4.5
1982.....	59.6	6.0	2022.....	163.6	7.7
1983.....	62.1	4.2	2023.....	170.0	3.9
1984.....	64.7	4.2	2024.....	174.4	2.6
1985.....	66.9	3.4	2025 ²	178.7	2.5
1986.....	68.0	1.6			

X Not applicable.

¹ To account for changes in the cost of living, the Census Bureau adjusts all prior year income and earnings estimates for inflation using price indexes produced by the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS). The Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U) is used between 2000 and 2025, and the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers Retroactive Series (R-CPI-U-RS) is used between 1978 and 1999. For 1967 to 1977, the Census Bureau uses the CPI-U-X1 series, which is an experimental series that preceded the R-CPI-U-RS and estimates the inflation rate in the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U) when applying the current rental equivalence method of measuring the cost of homeownership for years prior to 1983. For years before 1967, the Census Bureau uses the CPI-U. To combine these four series into one continuous series, the values in each range of years are proportionally adjusted using the ratio or ratios of index values from subsequent overlapping series years: 1967, 1978, and 2000. For example, CPI-U values prior to 1967 are adjusted to the C-CPI-U scale using the ratio of the CPI-U to CPI-U-X1 in 1967, the ratio of the CPI-U-X1 to R-CPI-U-RS in 1978, and the ratio of the C-CPI-U to the R-CPI-U-RS in 2000.

² The value for October 2025 is not available due to the 2025 lapse in appropriations. The missing monthly value was approximated by taking the geometric mean of the September 2025 and November 2025 index values. The annual index reported here is an average of the monthly indexes for 2025 and includes the approximated October 2025 value. More information on approximating missing data points is available from BLS at <www.bls.gov/cpi/factsheets/approximating-missing-data.htm>.

Note: Data users can compute the percentage changes in prices between earlier years' data and 2025 data by dividing the annual average C-CPI-U for 2025 by the annual average for the earlier year(s).

Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS), "Chained Consumer Price Index For All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U)," downloaded May 12, 2026, <www.bls.gov/cpi/additional-resources/chained-cpi.htm>; BLS, "R-CPI-U-RS Homepage," downloaded May 12, 2026, <www.bls.gov/cpi/research-series/r-cpi-u-rs-home.htm>; BLS, CPI-U-X1.

ENDNOTES

¹ For more information about the extent and nature of nonresponse and misreporting, refer to Adam Bee, Joshua Mitchell, Nikolas Mittag, Jonathan Rothbaum, Carl Sanders, Lawrence Schmidt, and Matthew Unrath, "National Experimental Wellbeing Statistics," SEHSD Working Paper #2023-02, U.S. Census Bureau, Washington, DC, 2023, <www.census.gov/library/working-papers/2023/demo/SEHSD-WP2023-02.html>.

² Jonathan Rothbaum, "Comparing Income Aggregates: How Do the CPS and ACS Match the National Income and Product Accounts, 2007-2012," SEHSD Working Paper #2015-01, U.S. Census Bureau, Washington, DC, 2015, <www.census.gov/library/working-papers/2015/demo/SEHSD-WP2015-01.html>.

³ Christina Bijou and Emily A. Shrider, "Poverty in the United States: 2025," *Current Population Reports*, P60-290, U.S. Census Bureau, Washington, DC, September 2026, <www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-290.html>.

⁴ For more information on the deduction for tip and overtime income and estimates of the impact of including the deduction in the tax model, refer to <www.census.gov/library/working-papers/2026/demo/sehdsd-wp2026-20.html>.

Appendix B. Additional Information

SOURCE AND ACCURACY OF THE ESTIMATES

The Current Population Survey (CPS) is the longest-running survey conducted by the U.S. Census Bureau. The CPS is a household survey primarily used to collect employment data. The sample universe for the basic CPS consists of the resident civilian noninstitutionalized population of the United States. People in institutions, such as prisons, long-term care hospitals, and nursing homes, are not eligible to be interviewed in the CPS. Students living in dormitories are included in the estimates only if information about them is reported in an interview at their parents' home. Since the CPS is a household survey, people who are homeless and not living in shelters are not included in the sample.

The CPS Annual Social and Economic Supplement (CPS ASEC), the source for the estimates in this report, collects data in February, March, and April each year, asking detailed questions categorizing income into over 50 sources. The key purpose of the survey is to provide timely and comprehensive estimates of income, poverty, and health insurance, and to measure change in these national-level estimates. The survey is the official source of national poverty estimates calculated in accordance with the Office of Management and Budget's Statistical Policy Directive 14.

The CPS ASEC collects data in the 50 states and the District of Columbia; these data do not

represent residents of Puerto Rico or the U.S. Island Areas.¹ The 2026 CPS ASEC sample consists of about 88,000 addresses. The CPS ASEC includes military personnel who live in a household with at least one civilian adult, regardless of whether they live on or off post. All other U.S. armed forces personnel are excluded. The estimates in this report are controlled to March 2026 independent national population estimates by age, sex, race, and Hispanic origin. Beginning with the data for 2020, population estimates are based on 2020 Census population counts and are updated annually after accounting for births, deaths, emigration, and immigration.

All 2024 estimates in this report and accompanying tables have been updated to incorporate Vintage 2025 population estimates and may not match previously published estimates. More information on the effect on 2024 estimates is available at <www.census.gov/library/working-papers/2026/demo/sehsd-wp2026-16.html>, and details on the Vintage 2025 population estimate methodology are available at <<https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/popest/technical-documentation/methodology/2020-2025/methods-statement-v2025.pdf>>.

The estimates in this report (which may be shown in the text and figures) and in the accompanying online tables available at <www.census.gov/library/publications/2026/demo/p60-289.html> are based on responses from a sample of the population

and may differ from actual values because of sampling variability or other factors. As a result, apparent differences between the estimates for two or more groups may not be statistically significant. All comparative statements have undergone statistical testing and are statistically significant at the 90 percent confidence level unless otherwise noted.

In this report and the accompanying online tables, the variances of estimates were calculated using replication methods. For estimates prior to 2010, or as noted in historical tables, the Generalized Variance Function (GVF) method was used. More information on replicate weights, standard errors, income top-coding and data swapping on the public-use file, and changes to the CPS ASEC data file from the prior year is available at <<https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar26.pdf>>.

Nonresponse Bias in the CPS ASEC

The Census Bureau administers the CPS ASEC each year between February and April by telephone and in-person interviews, with most data collected in March. Although the 2026 CPS ASEC was collected using standard procedures, response rates are still lower than they were before the pandemic. The weighted response rate for the 2026 CPS ASEC was 61.3 percent, compared to 62.0 percent for the previous year.

Since response rates remain below prepandemic levels, examining how respondents differ from nonrespondents is important, as this difference could affect the accuracy of the estimates. For more details on how sample difference and the associated nonresponse bias impact income and official poverty estimates, refer to the Research Matters blog, “Using Administrative Data to Evaluate Nonresponse Bias in the 2026 Current Population Survey Annual Social and Economic Supplement,” available at <www.census.gov/newsroom/blogs/research-matters/2026/09/evaluating-nonresponse-bias.html>.

CPS ASEC MODERNIZATION

The Census Bureau has begun a multiyear effort to modernize many of its surveys, including the CPS. Part of this involves adding an Internet Self-Response (ISR) mode to the CPS and then the CPS ASEC.

This project requires extensive review and testing to ensure that ISR is a viable collection mode for the CPS ASEC and that changes do not negatively affect the reliability and comparability of the estimates. The project schedule seeks to align the CPS ASEC modernization effort with that of the CPS to maintain continuity. However, the schedule and activities may change to accommodate funding availability, discovery of issues during testing and analysis, and project reprioritization.

More information about the ASEC modernization project and timeline is available on the Census Bureau’s CPS ASEC Modernization Efforts webpage at <www.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/about/modernization/asecmodernization.html> or by email at <demo.asec.modernization@census.gov>.

NATIONAL EXPERIMENTAL WELL-BEING STATISTICS (NEWS) PROJECT

The NEWS project is an experimental effort to develop improved estimates of income, poverty, and other measures of economic well-being by looking at data collected in previous years, using a wider range of data sources, and applying new advanced analysis techniques.

The first NEWS release in February 2023 included a working paper that provided improved estimates of income and official poverty statistics for 2018. The second NEWS release, in January 2025, expanded on the first release by creating additional measures of disposable income, a resource measure that includes nonhealth means-tested in-kind benefits, and the income component of the Supplemental Poverty Measure (SPM). The release also made several important improvements, most notably estimates of federal and state taxes and credits, the inclusion of additional administrative data on means-tested program benefits, and an update to the model that combines survey and

administrative earnings to estimate the unobserved true earnings distribution. In July 2025, NEWS was expanded to include income and poverty estimates from 2016 to 2021.

More information on the NEWS Project is available at <www.census.gov/data/experimental-data-products/national-experimental-wellbeing-statistics.html>.

ACCESSING INCOME DATA

Additional CPS ASEC Estimates

Additional estimates from the CPS ASEC are available on the Census Bureau’s income websites. These include detailed tables, historical tables, press releases, briefings, and working papers. The websites may be accessed through the Census Bureau’s home page at <www.census.gov> or directly at <www.census.gov/topics/income-poverty.html>.

Public-Use Microdata

Public-use CPS ASEC microdata are available for data users of all skill levels. Data users can create custom statistics from public-use microdata files using the Microdata Access Tool (MDAT), available at <<https://data.census.gov/mdat>>.

Microdata for the current CPS ASEC and earlier years are available online at <www.census.gov/data/datasets/time-series/demo/cps/cps-asec.html>. Technical methods have been applied to CPS microdata to avoid disclosing respondents’ identities.

OTHER SOURCES OF INCOME DATA

Since the CPS ASEC produces thorough and timely estimates of income, the Census Bureau recommends that people use it for national estimates. However, the Census Bureau produces other data that are appropriate for subnational areas and that can be used for longitudinal analysis. The American Community Survey (ACS) and the Small Area Income and Poverty Estimates (SAIPE) program can be used for subnational income estimates, while the Survey of Income and Program Participation (SIPP) provides monthly and longitudinal estimates.

American Community Survey (ACS)

The ACS is an ongoing survey that collects comprehensive information on social, economic, and housing topics. Due to its large sample size, the ACS provides estimates at many levels of geography and for smaller population groups.

The Census Bureau presents annual estimates of income by state and other smaller geographic units based on data collected in the ACS. Single-year estimates from the ACS are available for geographic units with populations of 65,000 or more. Estimates of income and poverty for all geographic units, including census tracts and block groups, are available by pooling 5 years of ACS data. Estimates from the ACS are available at <<https://data.census.gov>>.

Small Area Income and Poverty Estimates (SAIPE) Program

The SAIPE program uses statistical models to produce estimates of median household income and poverty for states and all counties, as well as population and poverty estimates for school districts. Statistics from the SAIPE program are used by the Department of Education to allocate funding under Title I of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act. SAIPE methodology combines data from a variety of sources, including administrative records, population estimates, the decennial census, and the ACS, to provide consistent and reliable single-year estimates for all counties and school districts regardless of size each year. In general, SAIPE estimates have lower variances than ACS estimates but offer fewer demographic details than the ACS. Estimates from this program are available at <www.census.gov/programs-surveys/saipe.html>.

Survey of Income and Program Participation (SIPP)

The SIPP provides both monthly and longitudinal data about labor force participation and income sources and amounts at the individual, family, and household level by following the same respondents over time. Whereas the CPS ASEC provides reliable estimates of the net change from one year to the next in the overall distribution of economic characteristics for the whole population, it cannot show how these characteristics change for the same person, family, or household. By collecting monthly

data for the same respondents over multiple years, the SIPP makes it possible to observe how economic characteristics change at the individual level. This yields insights into the dynamic nature of these experiences, as well as the economic mobility of U.S. residents. Estimates from these data are available in table packages, working papers, and the Census Bureau's P70 series reports, all available at <www.census.gov/programs-surveys/sipp/library/publications.html>.

QUESTIONS AND COMMENTS

For questions and assistance with income data, contact the U.S. Census Bureau Customer Service Center at 1-800-923-8282 (toll-free) or search your topic of interest using the Census Bureau's "Question and Answer Center" found at <<https://census.gov/help/>>.

The Census Bureau also welcomes the comments and advice of data and report users. If you have suggestions or comments on this report, please email Liana Fox at <liana.e.fox@census.gov> or write to:

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ENDNOTE

¹ U.S. Island Areas include American Samoa, Guam, the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, and the U.S. Virgin Islands.

